

Katari was among the first batch of young men trained on the Dufferin, a training ship (like the one shown here) set up in 1927 in response to Indian demands for maritime training opportunities. He did very well both academically and in the physical training activities and received the first Viceroy's Medal, which was awarded to the best cadet in a cohort.

From the old to the new

Katari held several important positions overseeing both the navy's personnel and fleet before he rose to the position of Chief of the Naval Staff in 1958. During these years, he helped lay the foundations of independent India's naval administration and management including the recruitment and training of Indian officers who could take up higher positions. As Navy Chief, Katari was constrained by a lack of resources and thus unable to expand the navy significantly. He focused instead on bolstering morale, promoting more equitable relations between officers and their men, and building India's indigenous capacities in defence production and maintenance as well as training.